belief in nonalignment and multiple paths to socialism. The Chinese and Soviet refusal to send delegations to the Yugoslav party congress and their subsequent propaganda offensive against Yugoslavia dismayed Nehru. Their condemnation suggested that they no longer seemed willing to tolerate various routes to socialism. Furthermore, Nehru was concerned that this signaled a return to the "crusading attitude of the Communist Party which was one of interference."[178] Nehru worried particularly about Beijing's "language of violence"; peaceful coexistence had "gone by the board." This was linked to a parochial concern: "If the Soviet Union or China can do this in regard to Yugoslavia, there is no particular reason to imagine that they cannot or will not do so in the case of India."[179]

The second development was the "cold-blooded" communist execution of detained Hungarian leader Imre Nagy in June 1958. It was a "great shock" to Nehru and other officials, as well as the public. The prime minister told the Indian envoy in Moscow that the communist steps were "amazingly foolish." The Chinese celebratory reaction was "even worse," and significant given that its attitude toward India had also "stiffened."[180]

These incidents also significantly affected views of the Soviet Union in India and consolidated Nehru's discomfort with Moscow's method of dealing with smaller countries. He had believed its actions in Hungary in 1956 had been "deplorable"[181] and conveyed to Soviet premier Nikolai Bulganin his disapproval of strong countries coercing weaker ones.[182] These concerns were reinforced in May 1958 when Moscow suspended credits to Yugoslavia because of political differences. Nehru told Indian chief ministers that this was a "breach of an agreement." There was broader concern within the government about the implications for India.[183] Subsequently, when reports emerged that Moscow was trying to use economic coercion to change Finland's political choices, the Indian foreign secretary sarcastically noted, "Soviet Gov[ernmen]t profess[es] that they give aid and do trade without any political strings."[184]

These incidents lent credibility to Yugoslav leader Josip Broz Tito's remark to the Indian ambassador in Belgrade that Moscow wanted "camp-followers" rather than a "fraternity."[185] After Nagy's execution, Nehru made his disapproval clear in an August 1958 article for the Congress Party journal that was republished in the *New York Times*. It criticized